

★COMBAT SYSTEMS OFFICER UTILIZATION FIELD (12XX)

Introduction
(Changed 31 Oct 23)

The Combat Systems Officer (CSO) Utilization Field encompasses all functions performed by rated CSOs to conduct or directly support flying operations, including combat, combat support, and training missions. Inherently included are supervisory and staff functions such as inspection, contingency planning, and policy formulation.

Specific instruction on use of certain AFSCs:

Identify CSOs by the 12XX specialties appropriate to the type of missions and weapon system involved. Use the following prefixes to identify additional rated qualifications and experience, and unit manpower document positions that require these capabilities:

- A Operational Warfare Instructor
- B Squadron Operations/Operations Support
- C Commander
- E Electronic Warfare
- F Aircraft Systems Flight Evaluation
- G Automated Systems Program Designer
- H Military Consultant to the Surgeon General
- J Parachutist
- K Instructor for weapon system designated by AFSC
- L Aircrew Flight Equipment
- M Medical Service Specialist (Physiological Training Instructor)
- Q Standardization or Flight Examiner for weapon system designated by AFSC
- R Contingency/War Plans
- S Safety
- T Formal Training Instructor
- U Information Operations
- V Automated Functional Applications Analyst
- W Weapons and Tactics Instructor
- Y Analytical Studies

Identify CSOs serving as instructors in undergraduate training and formal training units (FTU) with a T prefix. Do not award the T prefix to instructor CSOs in operational units. Prefix K identifies these instructors and authorizations.

★CSOs assigned to duty as Aerospace Physiology Instructors, after completion of formal training, may be identified by prefix M. The office of the CFM, Aerospace Physiology, HAF/A3TH, validates positions and awards AFSCs.

Identify requirements for staff officers above wing level with a staff AFSC (12X4), where appropriate. Not all positions above wing level qualify for the staff AFSC. For those positions above wing level, Manpower will use the staff AFSC requirements for determining applicability: **Staff Air Force Specialty Code**—Identifies an officer position above wing level specifically on the duty requirements of the role performed, not the fact that the authorization is on a staff above wing level. Use staff AFSCs (XXX4) to identify **planning** and **policy-making** positions **above** wing level. It requires the same skills as those for the qualified AFSC (XXX3), but applied to **developing broad policies, plans, and procedures**. Management responsibility increases without a corresponding increase in knowledge of the technical aspects of the function. Qualified officers filling/have filled such positions are awarded the staff AFSC. Award individuals possessing a qualified AFSC (12X3) or a staff AFSC (12X4) upon assignment to a position so identified.

Qualification level 3 designates a CSO qualified in the assigned specialty or shredout. Level 2 may be used to designate qualification at an intermediate level, if appropriate, for a specific shredout in AFSC 12BX. Level 1 identifies rated CSOs at the entry level for their specialty.

Current aeronautical rating and qualification for aviation service according to AFI 11-402, *Aviation and Parachutists Service*, are mandatory for award and retention of CSO AFSCs. See AFMAN 36-2100, *Military Utilization & Classification*, for policy on retention or withdrawal of rated AFSCs for personnel disqualified from aviation service or placed in an inactive status.

AFSC 12B4*, Staff
 AFSC 12B3*, Qualified
 AFSC 12B2*, Intermediate
 AFSC 12B1*, Entry/Student

BOMBER COMBAT SYSTEMS OFFICER (Changed 31 Oct 21)

1. Specialty Summary. Performs duties of navigator, electronic warfare officer (EWO), or weapon systems officer (WSO) to accomplish combat, training, and other assigned missions. Related DoD Occupational Group: 220400.

2. Duties and Responsibilities:

2.1. Plans and prepares for mission. Reviews mission tasking, intelligence, and weather information. Participates in mission planning, preparation and filing of flight plan, and crew briefing. Ensures aircraft is preflighted, inspected, loaded, equipped, and manned for mission.

2.2. Navigates aircraft to accomplish assigned mission. Operates available navigation systems.

2.3. Conducts or supervises training of crewmembers. Ensures operational readiness of crew by conducting or supervising mission specific training.

2.4. Develops plans and policies, monitors operations, and advises commanders. Assists commanders and performs staff functions related to this specialty.

3. Specialty Qualifications:

3.1. Knowledge. Knowledge is mandatory of theory of flight, air navigation, meteorology, flying directives, aircraft operating procedures, and mission tactics.

3.2. Education. For entry into this specialty, an undergraduate degree specializing in physical sciences, mathematics, administration, or management is desirable.

3.3. Training. The following training is mandatory as indicated:

3.3.1. For entry into this specialty, completion of Air Force Specialized Undergraduate Navigator Training (SUNT) or Undergraduate CSO Training.

3.3.2. For award of AFSC 12B2X/3X, completion of transition and operational training in the suffix specific aircraft.

3.3.3. For award of AFSC 12B3C/D/W, completion of a EWO course or Undergraduate CSO Training.

3.4. Experience. For upgrade to AFSCs 12B2X/3X, unit commander determines proficiency based on performance, experience, and completion of minimum training requirements.

3.5. Other. The following are mandatory as indicated:

3.5.1. For award and retention of these AFSCs, current aeronautical rating and qualification for aviation service as navigator.

3.5.2. Specialty requires routine access to Tier 5 (T5) information, systems or similar classified environments. For award and retention of AFSCs 12BXX, completion of a current T5 Investigation IAW DoDM 5200.02_AFMAN 16-1405, *Air Force Personnel Security Program*.

NOTE: Award of the entry level without a completed T5 Investigation is authorized provided an interim Top Secret security clearance has been granted according to DoDM 5200.02_AFMAN 16 -1405.

4. *Specialty Shredouts:

<i>Suffix</i>	<i>Portion of AFS to Which Related</i>
C	B-1 WSO
D	B-52 EWO
E	B-52 WSO
U	Air Liaison Officer (ALO)
W	EWO, General
Y	General
Z	Other

AFSC 12E4*, Staff
 AFSC 12E3*, Qualified
 AFSC 12E1*, Entry/Student

EXPERIMENTAL TEST COMBAT SYSTEMS OFFICER (Changed 30 Apr 17)

1. Specialty Summary. Plans, conducts, directs, and reports on flight test programs associated with the design, development, and modification of aircraft, aerospace vehicles, flight simulators, and related systems. Related DoD Occupational Group: 220400.

2. Duties and Responsibilities:

- 2.1. Plans and conducts flight test programs. Formulates test procedures and conducts tests to evaluate structural integrity, performance, handling characteristics, reliability, and suitability of aircraft and systems.
- 2.2. Manages research, test and evaluation projects, and programs. Integrates test objectives, organizes and directs test forces, supervises flight operations.
- 2.3. Identifies design and operational deficiencies and recommends improvements. Prepares technical reports and recommends design improvements.
- 2.4. Develops plans and policies, monitors operations, and advises commanders. Assists commanders and performs staff functions related to this specialty.

3. Specialty Qualifications:

- 3.1. Knowledge. Knowledge is mandatory of aircraft performance and handling fundamentals, operational employment concepts, and flight test procedures.
- 3.2. Education. For entry into this specialty, an undergraduate degree specializing in physical sciences, mathematics, or engineering is mandatory.
- 3.3. Training. The following training is mandatory as indicated:
 - 3.3.1. For entry into this specialty, completion of Air Force Specialized Undergraduate Navigator Training (SUNT) or Undergraduate CSO Training.
 - 3.3.2. For award of AFSC 12E3X, completion of the Air Force Test Pilot School, Experimental Test Navigator Course/Experimental Test CSO Course, or equivalent US Navy or foreign test navigator course.
 - 3.3.3. For award of AFSC 12E3S/W, completion of an electronic warfare officer (EWO) course or Undergraduate CSO Training.
- 3.4. Experience. For upgrade to AFSC 12E3X, unit commander determines proficiency based on performance, experience, and completion of minimum training requirements.
- 3.5. Other. For award and retention of these AFSCs, current aeronautical rating and qualification for aviation service as CSO are mandatory.
- 3.5.1. Specialty requires routine access to Tier 5 (T5) information, systems or similar classified environments. For award and retention of AFSCs 12EXX, completion of a current T5 Investigation IAW DoDM 5200.02_AFMAN 16-1405, *Air Force Personnel Security Program*.

NOTE: Award of the entry level without a completed SSBI is authorized provided an interim SSBI has been granted according to DoDM 5200.02_AFMAN 16 -1405.

4. *Specialty Shredouts:

<i>Suffix</i>	<i>Portion of AFS to Which Related</i>
A	Airlift/Tanker/Bomber
B	Fighter
D	Airlift
E	Tanker
F	Bomber
G	RPA
W	EWO, General
Y	General
Z	Other

AFSC 12F4*, Staff
 AFSC 12F3*, Qualified
 AFSC 12F1*, Entry/Student

FIGHTER COMBAT SYSTEMS OFFICER (Changed 31 Oct 22)

1. Specialty Summary. Performs duties of weapon systems officer (WSO), electronic warfare officer (EWO), to accomplish combat, training, and other assigned missions. Related DoD Occupational Group: 220400.

2. Duties and Responsibilities:

- 2.1. Plans and prepares for mission. Reviews mission tasking, intelligence, and weather information. Participates in mission planning, preparation and filing of flight plan, and crew briefing. Ensures aircraft is preflighted, inspected, loaded, equipped, and manned for mission.
- 2.2. Navigates aircraft to accomplish assigned mission. Operates available navigation systems.
- 2.3. Conducts or supervises training of crewmembers. Ensures operational readiness of crew by conducting or supervising mission specific training.
- 2.4. Develops plans and policies, monitors operations, and advises commanders. Assists commanders and performs staff functions related to this specialty.

3. Specialty Qualifications:

- 3.1. Knowledge. Knowledge is mandatory of theory of flight, air navigation, meteorology, flying directives, aircraft operating procedures, and mission tactics.
- 3.2. Education. For entry into this specialty, an undergraduate degree specializing in physical sciences, mathematics, administration, or management is desirable.
- 3.3. Training. The following training is mandatory as indicated:
 - 3.3.1. For entry into this specialty, completion of Air Force Specialized Undergraduate Navigator Training (SUNT) or Undergraduate CSO Training.
 - 3.3.2. For award of AFSC 12F3X, completion of transition and operational training in the suffix specific aircraft.
 - 3.3.3. For award of AFSCs 12F3B/C/E/G/J/K/S/W, completion of a EWO course or Undergraduate CSO Training.
- 3.4. Experience. For upgrade to AFSCs 12F3X, unit commander determines proficiency based on performance, experience, and completion of minimum training requirements.
- 3.5. Other. The following are mandatory as indicated:
 - 3.5.1. For award and retention of these AFSCs, current aeronautical rating and qualification for aviation service as CSO are mandatory.
 - 3.5.2. Specialty requires routine access to Tier 5 (T5) information, systems or similar classified environments. For award and retention of AFSCs 12FXX, completion of a current T5 Investigation IAW DoDM 5200.02_AFMAN 16-1405, *Air Force Personnel Security Program*.

NOTE: Award of the entry level without a completed T5 Investigation is authorized provided an interim Top Secret security clearance has been granted according to DoDM 5200.02_AFMAN 16 -1405.

4. *Specialty Shredouts:

Suffix Portion of AFS to Which Related

F	F-15E WSO
G	F-15E EWO
Q	T-7
U	Air Liaison Officer (ALO)
V	EA-18G
W	EWO, General
Y	General
Z	Other

AFSC 12G4*, Staff
AFSC 12G3*, Qualified

GENERALIST COMBAT SYSTEMS OFFICER (Changed 30 Apr 12)

1. Specialty Summary. Develops plans and policies, monitors and evaluates operations, coordinates staff activities, and advises commanders. Related DOD Occupational Group: 220700.

2. Duties and Responsibilities. Monitors, evaluates, and directs flying operations and training programs. Develops requirements for equipment and training. Prepares and coordinates budgets. Analyzes rated manpower requirements and formulates personnel policies. Prepares, coordinates, and disseminates policy directives and implementing instructions. Develops contingency plans.

3. Specialty Qualifications.

3.1. Knowledge. Not used.

3.2. Education. Not used.

3.3. Training. Not used

3.4. Experience. Not used.

3.5. Other. The following are mandatory as indicated:

3.5.1. For award of AFSCs 12GX3/4, prior qualification in any navigator AFSC (12X3).

3.5.2. For award of AFSCs 12G3W/4W, prior qualification in any electronic warfare officer (EWO) AFSC (12X3X).

3.5.3. For award and retention of this AFSC, current aeronautical rating and no permanent disqualification for aviation service as CSO.

3.5.4. Specialty requires routine access to Tier 5 (T5) information, systems or similar classified environments. For award and retention of AFSCs 12GXX, completion of a current T5 Investigation IAW DoDM 5200.02_AFMAN 16-1405, *Air Force Personnel Security Program*.

NOTE: Award of the entry level without a completed T5 Investigation is authorized provided an interim Top Secret security clearance has been granted according to DoDM 5200.02_AFMAN 16 -1405.

4. *Specialty Shredouts:

<i>Suffix</i>	<i>Portion of AFS to Which Related</i>
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W	EWO
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NOTE: These AFSCs are only authorized to identify non-flying positions where designation of a specific CSO or EWO AFSC is not feasible.

AFSC 12H4*, Staff
 AFSC 12H3*, Qualified
 AFSC 12H1*, Entry/Student

RESCUE COMBAT SYSTEMS OFFICER (Established 31 Jan 12)

1. Specialty Summary. Performs duties of navigator to accomplish rescue and other assigned missions. Related DoD Occupational Group: 220400.

2. Duties and Responsibilities:

- 2.1. Plans and prepares for mission. Reviews mission tasking, intelligence, and weather information. Participates in mission planning, preparation and filing of flight plan, and crew briefing. Ensures aircraft is preflighted, inspected, loaded, equipped, and manned for mission.
- 2.2. Navigates aircraft to accomplish assigned mission. Operates available navigation systems.
- 2.3. Conducts or supervises training of crewmembers. Ensures operational readiness of crew by conducting or supervising mission specific training.
- 2.4. Develops plans and policies, monitors operations, and advises commanders. Assists commanders by performing staff functions related to this specialty.

3. Specialty Qualifications:

- 3.1. Knowledge. Knowledge is mandatory of theory of flight, air navigation, meteorology, flying directives, aircraft operating procedures, and mission tactics.
- 3.2. Education. For entry into this specialty, an undergraduate degree specializing in physical sciences, mathematics, administration, or management is desirable.
- 3.3. Training. The following training is mandatory as indicated:
 - 3.3.1. For entry into this specialty, completion of Air Force Specialized Undergraduate Navigator Training (SUNT) or Undergraduate CSO Training.
 - 3.3.2. For award of AFSC 12H3X, completion of transition and operational training in the suffix specific aircraft.
- 3.4. Experience. For upgrade to AFSCs 12H3X, unit commander determines proficiency based on performance, experience, and completion of minimum training requirements.
- 3.5. Other. The following are mandatory as indicated:
 - 3.5.1. For award and retention of these AFSCs, current aeronautical rating and qualification for aviation service as CSO.
 - 3.5.2. Specialty requires routine access to Tier 5 (T5) information, systems or similar classified environments. For award and retention of AFSCs 12HXX, completion of a current T5 Investigation IAW DoDM 5200.02_AFMAN 16-1405, *Air Force Personnel Security Program*.

NOTE 1: Award of the entry level without a completed T5 Investigation is authorized provided an interim Top Secret security clearance has been granted according to DoDM 5200.02_AFMAN 16 -1405.

4. *Specialty Shredouts:

<i>Suffix</i>	<i>Portion of AFS to Which Related</i>
J	HC-130J
P	HC-130
Y	General
Z	Other

AFSC 12K4*, Staff
 AFSC 12K3*, Qualified
 AFSC 12K1*, Entry/Student

TRAINER COMBAT SYSTEMS OFFICER (Changed 31 Jan 10)

1. Specialty Summary. Performs duties of a trainer CSO to accomplish CSO training and other assigned missions. Related DoD Occupational Group: 220400.

2. Duties and Responsibilities:

- 2.1. Plans and prepares for mission. Reviews syllabus requirements, student progress, and weather information. Participates in mission planning, preparation and filing of flight plan, and crew briefing. Ensures aircraft is preflighted, inspected, loaded, equipped, and manned for mission.
- 2.2. Navigates aircraft to accomplish assigned mission. Operates available navigation systems.
- 2.3. Conducts or supervises training of students. Ensures optimum training opportunities and progress by conducting or supervising student training.
- 2.4. Develops plans and policies, monitors operations, and advises commanders. Assists commanders and performs staff functions related to this specialty.

3. Specialty Qualifications:

- 3.1. Knowledge. Knowledge is mandatory of theory of flight, air navigation, meteorology, flying directives, aircraft operating procedures, and mission tactics.
- 3.2. Education. For entry into this specialty, an undergraduate degree specializing in physical sciences, mathematics, administration, or management is desirable.
- 3.3. Training. The following training is mandatory as indicated:
 - 3.3.1. For entry into this specialty, completion of Air Force Specialized Undergraduate Navigator Training (SUNT) or Undergraduate CSO Training.
 - 3.3.2. For award of AFSC 12K3X, completion of operational training applicable to the suffix designation.
 - 3.3.3. For award of AFSC 12K3B, completion of an electronic warfare officer (EWO) course.
 - 3.3.4. For award of AFSC 12K3D, completion of undergraduate CSO training, or graduate EWO/CSO training.
- 3.4. Experience. For award of AFSC 12K3X, unit commander determines proficiency based on performance, experience, and completion of minimum training requirements.
- 3.5. Other. For award and retention of these AFSCs, a current aeronautical rating and qualification for aviation service as navigator are mandatory.

4. *Specialty Shredouts:

<i>Suffix</i>	<i>Portion of AFS to Which Related</i>
A	SUNT, Navigator General
B	SUNT, EWO
C	SUNT, WSO
D	Instructor, Undergraduate CSO Training
Y	General
Z	Other

AFSC 12M4*, Staff
 AFSC 12M3*, Qualified
 AFSC 12M1*, Entry/Student

MOBILITY COMBAT SYSTEMS OFFICER (Changed 30 Apr 15)

1. Specialty Summary. Performs duties of CSO to accomplish mobility, training, and other assigned missions. Related DoD Occupational Group: 220400.

2. Duties and Responsibilities:

2.1. Plans and prepares for mission. Reviews mission tasking, intelligence, and weather information. Participates in mission planning, preparation and filing of flight plan, and crew briefing. Ensures aircraft is preflighted, inspected, loaded, equipped, and manned for mission.

2.2. Navigates aircraft to accomplish assigned mission. Operates available navigation systems.

2.3. Conducts or supervises training of crewmembers. Ensures operational readiness of crew by conducting or supervising mission specific training.

2.4. Develops plans and policies, monitors operations, and advises commanders. Assists commanders and performs staff functions related to this specialty.

3. Specialty Qualifications:

3.1. Knowledge. Knowledge is mandatory of theory of flight, air navigation, meteorology, flying directives, aircraft operating procedures, and mission tactics.

3.2. Education. For entry into this specialty, an undergraduate degree specializing in physical sciences, mathematics, administration, or management is desirable.

3.3. Training. The following training is mandatory as indicated:

3.3.1. For entry into this specialty, completion of Air Force Specialized Undergraduate Navigator Training (SUNT) or Undergraduate CSO Training.

3.3.2. For award of AFSC 12M3X, completion of transition and operational training in the suffix specific aircraft.

3.4. Experience. For upgrade to AFSCs 12M3X, unit commander determines proficiency based on performance, experience, and completion of minimum training requirements.

3.5. Other. For award and retention of these AFSCs, current aeronautical rating and qualification for aviation service as CSO are mandatory.

4. *Specialty Shredouts:

<i>Suffix</i>	<i>Portion of AFS to Which Related</i>
B	C-130E/H
E	VC-25
F	KC-135
S	Airlift, General
T	Tanker, General
U	Air Mobility Liaison Officer (AMLO)
V	Inter-Theater Airlift, General
W	Intra-Theater Airlift, General
Y	General
Z	Other

AFSC 12R4*, Staff
 AFSC 12R3*, Qualified
 AFSC 12R1*, Entry/Student

RECONNAISSANCE/SURVEILLANCE/ELECTRONIC WARFARE COMBAT SYSTEMS OFFICER (Changed 30 Apr 23)

1. Specialty Summary. Performs duties of navigator or electronic warfare officer (EWO) to accomplish reconnaissance, surveillance, search and rescue, electronic combat, training, and other assigned missions. Related DoD Occupational Group: 220400.

2. Duties and Responsibilities:

- 2.1. Plans and prepares for mission. Reviews mission tasking, intelligence, and weather information. Participates in mission planning, preparation and filing of flight plan, and crew briefing. Ensures aircraft is preflighted, inspected, loaded, equipped, and manned for mission.
- 2.2. Navigates aircraft to accomplish assigned mission. Operates available navigation systems.
- 2.3. Conducts or supervises training of crewmembers. Ensures operational readiness of crew by conducting or supervising mission specific training.
- 2.4. Develops plans and policies, monitors operations, and advises commanders. Assists commanders by performing staff functions related to this specialty.

3. Specialty Qualifications:

- 3.1. Knowledge. Knowledge is mandatory of theory of flight, air navigation, meteorology, flying directives, aircraft operating procedures, and mission tactics.
- 3.2. Education. For entry into this specialty, an undergraduate degree specializing in physical sciences, mathematics, administration, or management is desirable.
- 3.3. Training. The following training is mandatory as indicated:
 - 3.3.1. For entry into this specialty, completion of Air Force Specialized Undergraduate Navigator Training (SUNT) or Undergraduate CSO Training.
 - 3.3.2. For award of AFSC 12R3X, completion of transition and operational training in the suffix specific aircraft.
 - 3.3.3. For award of AFSCs 12R3C/H/M/W, completion of an EWO course or Undergraduate CSO Training.
- 3.4. Experience. For upgrade to AFSCs 12R3X, unit commander determines proficiency based on performance, experience, and completion of minimum training requirements.
- 3.5. Other. The following are mandatory as indicated:
 - 3.5.1. For award and retention of these AFSCs, current aeronautical rating and qualification for aviation service as CSO.
 - 3.5.2. Specialty requires routine access to Tier 5 (T5) information, systems or similar classified environments. For award and retention of AFSCs 12RXX, completion of a current T5 Investigation IAW DoDM 5200.02_AFMAN 16-1405, *Air Force Personnel Security Program*.

NOTE 1: Award of the entry level without a completed T5 Investigation is authorized provided an interim Top Secret security clearance has been granted according to DoDM 5200.02_AFMAN 16 -1405.

NOTE 2: Security requirement doesn't apply to F (WC130) Shredout.

4. *Specialty Shredouts:

<i>Suffix</i>	<i>Portion of AFS to Which Related</i>
A	E-3
B	E-4
C	EC-130 EWO
D	EC-130
F	WC-130
H	RC-135 EWO
J	RC-135
K	WC/OC-135
L	E-8
N	RC-26B
S	E-7 EWO
W	EWO, General
Y	General
Z	Other

AFSC 12S4*, Staff
 AFSC 12S3*, Qualified
 AFSC 12S1*, Entry/Student

SPECIAL OPERATIONS COMBAT SYSTEMS OFFICER (Changed 31 Oct 17)

1. Specialty Summary. Performs duties of navigator, fire control officer (FCO), or electronic warfare officer (EWO) to accomplish special operations, training, and other assigned missions. Related DoD Occupational Group: 220400.

2. Duties and Responsibilities:

- 2.1. Plans and prepares for mission. Reviews mission tasking, intelligence, and weather information. Participates in mission planning, preparation and filing of flight plan, and crew briefing. Ensures aircraft is preflighted, inspected, loaded, equipped, and manned for mission.
- 2.2. Navigates aircraft to accomplish assigned mission. Operates available navigation systems.
- 2.3. Conducts or supervises training of crewmembers. Ensures operational readiness of crew by conducting or supervising mission specific training.
- 2.4. Develops plans and policies, monitors operations, and advises commanders. Assists commanders and performs staff functions related to this specialty.

3. Specialty Qualifications:

- 3.1. Knowledge. Knowledge is mandatory of theory of flight, air navigation, meteorology, flying directives, aircraft operating procedures, and mission tactics.
- 3.2. Education. For entry into this specialty, an undergraduate degree specializing in physical sciences, mathematics, administration, or management is desirable.
- 3.3. Training. The following training is mandatory as indicated:
 - 3.3.1. For entry into this specialty, completion of Air Force Specialized Undergraduate Navigator Training (SUNT) or Undergraduate CSO Training.
 - 3.3.2. For award of AFSC 12S3x, completion of transition and operational training in the suffix specific aircraft.
 - 3.3.3. For award of AFSCs 12S3A/D/H/K/Q/S/W, completion of a EWO course or Undergraduate CSO Training.
- 3.4. Experience. For upgrade to AFSCs 12S3x, unit commander determines proficiency based on performance, experience, and completion of minimum training requirements.
- 3.5. Other. The following are mandatory as indicated:
 - 3.5.1. For award and retention of these AFSCs, current aeronautical rating and qualification for aviation service as CSO.
 - 3.5.2. Specialty requires routine access to Tier 5 (T5) information, systems or similar classified environments. For award and retention of AFSCs 12SxX, completion of a current T5 Investigation IAW DoDM 5200.02_AFMAN 16-1405, *Air Force Personnel Security Program*.

NOTE: Award of the entry level without a completed T5 Investigation is authorized provided an interim Top Secret security clearance has been granted according to DoDM 5200.02_AFMAN 16 -1405.

4. *Specialty Shredouts:

<i>Suffix</i>	<i>Portion of AFS to Which Related</i>	<i>Suffix</i>	<i>Portion of AFS to Which Related</i>
A	AC-130H EWO	N	AC-130W
B	AC-130H FCO	O	AC-130W FCO
C	AC-130H	P	MC-130J
D	AC-130U EWO	Q	AC-130J CSO
E	AC-130U FCO	R	AC-130J WSO
F	AC-130U	S	EC-130J
G	MC-130P	U	Air Liaison Officer
H	MC-130E EWO	W	EWO, General
J	MC-130E	X	U-28
K	MC-130H EWO	Y	General
L	MC-130H	Z	Other
M	Air Commando (CAA, NSAv, DM)		

AFSC 12U4*, Staff
 AFSC 12U3*, Qualified
 AFSC 12U1*, Entry/Student

REMOTELY PILOTED AIRCRAFT (RPA)
(Changed 31 Oct 12, Effective 27 Aug 12)

1. Specialty Summary. Operates specialized mission aircraft and commands flight crews to accomplish reconnaissance, surveillance, combat, training, and other missions. Related DoD Occupational Group: 220100.

2. Duties and Responsibilities:

2.1. Plans and prepares for mission. Reviews mission tasking, intelligence, and weather information. Supervises mission planning, equipment configuration, and crew briefing. Ensures ground station and aircraft are preflighted, inspected, loaded, and equipped for mission.

2.2. Operates aircraft and commands the crew. Operates aircraft controls and equipment. Performs, supervises, or directs navigation, surveillance, reconnaissance, and weapons employment operations.

2.3. Conducts or supervises training of crewmembers. Ensures operational readiness of crew by conducting or supervising mission specific training.

2.4. Develops plans and policies, monitors operations, and advises commanders. Assists commanders and performs staff functions related to this specialty.

3. Specialty Qualifications:

3.1. Knowledge. Knowledge is mandatory of theory of flight, air navigation, meteorology, flying directives, aircraft operating procedures, and mission tactics.

3.2. Education. For entry into this specialty, an undergraduate degree specializing in physical sciences, mathematics, administration, or management is desirable.

3.3. Training. For award of AFSC 12U3X, completion of transition and operational training in the suffix specific aircraft is mandatory.

3.4. Experience. For upgrade to AFSC 12U3X, unit commander determines proficiency based on performance, experience, and completion of minimum training requirements.

3.5. Other. The following are mandatory as indicated:

3.5.1. For award and retention of this AFSC:

3.5.1.1. Qualification for air vehicle operator duty according to AFI 48-123, *Medical Examinations and Standards*.

3.5.1.2. Current aeronautical rating and no permanent disqualification for aviation service as CSO.

3.5.2. For award of AFSC 12U3X, certification of aircraft commander qualification by appropriate operations authority.

4. *Specialty Shredouts:

<i>Suffix</i>	<i>Portion of AFS to Which Related</i>
A	MQ-1
B	MQ-9
C	RQ-4
E	RQ-170
S	Special Operations
U	Air Liaison Officer
Y	General
Z	Other